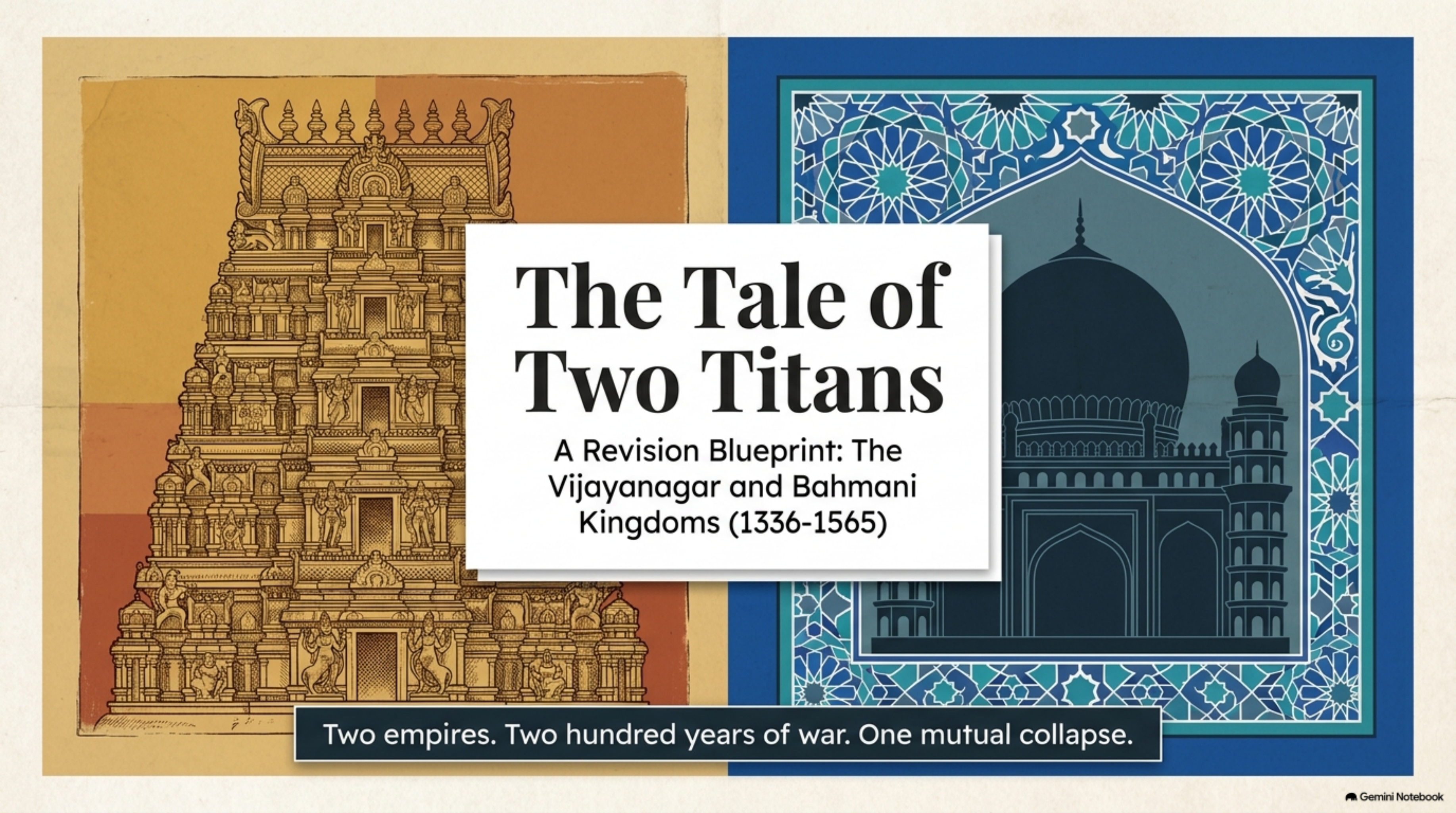




The Tale of Two Titans

A Revision Blueprint: The
Vijayanagar and Bahmani
Kingdoms (1336-1565)

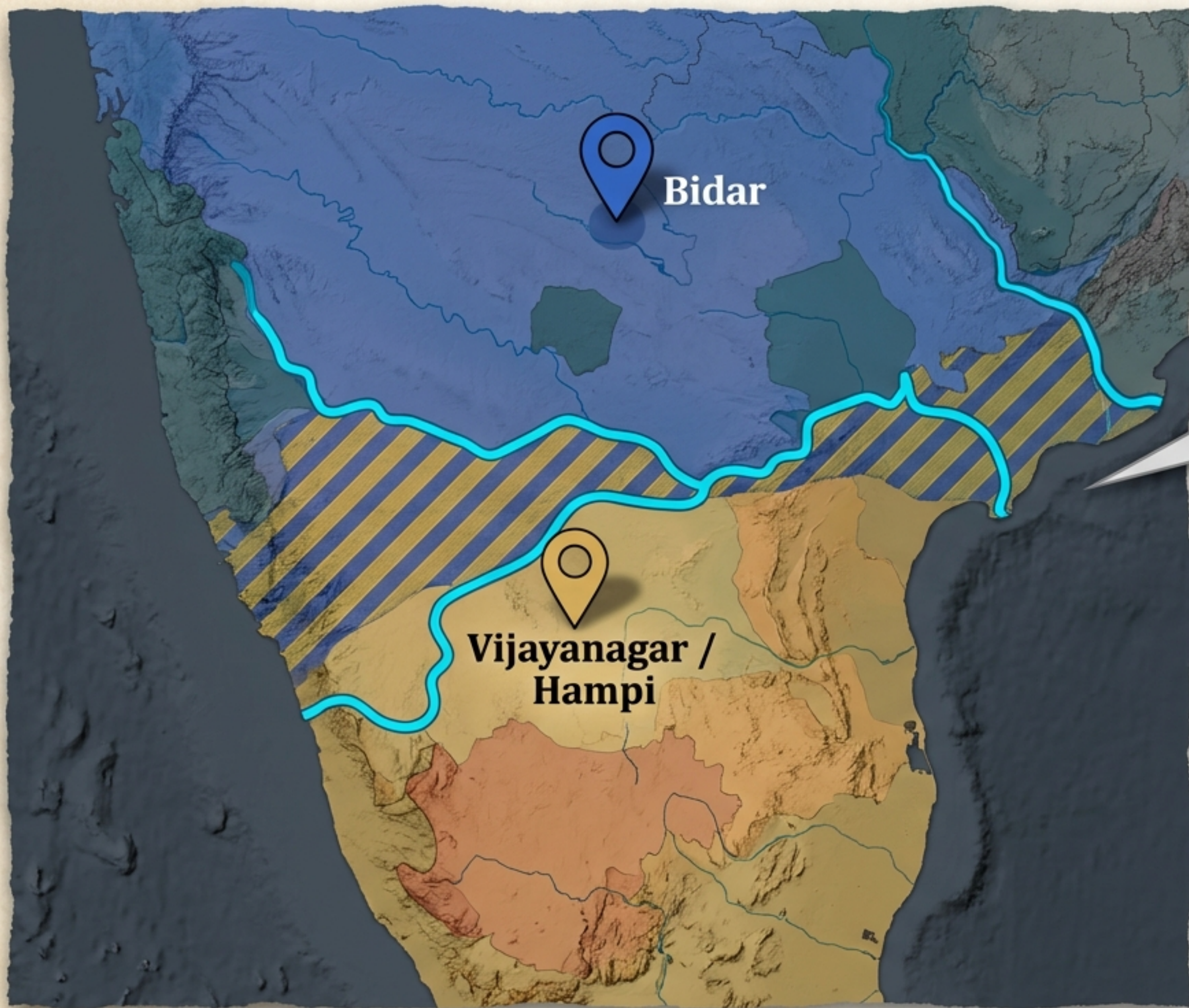
Two empires. Two hundred years of war. One mutual collapse.

The Geopolitical Game Board

The Power Vacuum: Both kingdoms surged into the space left by the crumbling Delhi Sultanate (Tughlaqs).

MEMORY KEY

The Geographic Divide:
South of Tungabhadra =
Vijayanagar.
North to the Krishna =
Bahmani.



Foundations in the 14th Century

1336 AD

- Founded by brothers **Harihar & Bukka Rai**.
- South of Tungabhadra river.

MEMORY KEY

1336 = 3+3=6
(The Two Brothers)

Born 11
years apart.
Destined to
clash for two
centuries.

1347 AD

- Founded by **Hasan Gangu** (Ala-ud-din Hassan Bahman Shah).
- Former Turkish Governor.

1347 = Hasan Gangu
strikes out from the Sultanate

Peak Leadership: Vijayanagar



Krishna Deva Raya

Died 1529

"An era of military dominance paired with unparalleled peace and prosperity."



Military Expansion

Conquered Raichur Doab (1512), subdued Odisha (1514), and defeated Bijapur Sultan (1520). Maintained constant military preparedness.



Trade & Infrastructure

Maintained highly profitable trade with the Portuguese. Built massive irrigation embankments to create agricultural reservoirs.



Cultural Patronage

Accomplished scholar and poet. Added massive gopurams to temples. Founded the suburban township of Nagalapuram.

Peak Administration: Bahmani



Mohammad Gawan
(1460–1481)

“The Persian merchant who became the backbone of the Bahmani Empire.”



Military Centralization:

Shifted military power away from Jagirdars directly to the Sultan. Conquered Goa and Kanchipuram.



Administrative Reform:

Introduced a fair justice system. Divided 4 large provinces into 8 smaller ‘Tarafs’ to severely reduce governor powers.



Educational Legacy:

Built the grand Madrassa at Bidar, establishing an institution of higher learning with a library of 3,000 books.



The Tragic End:

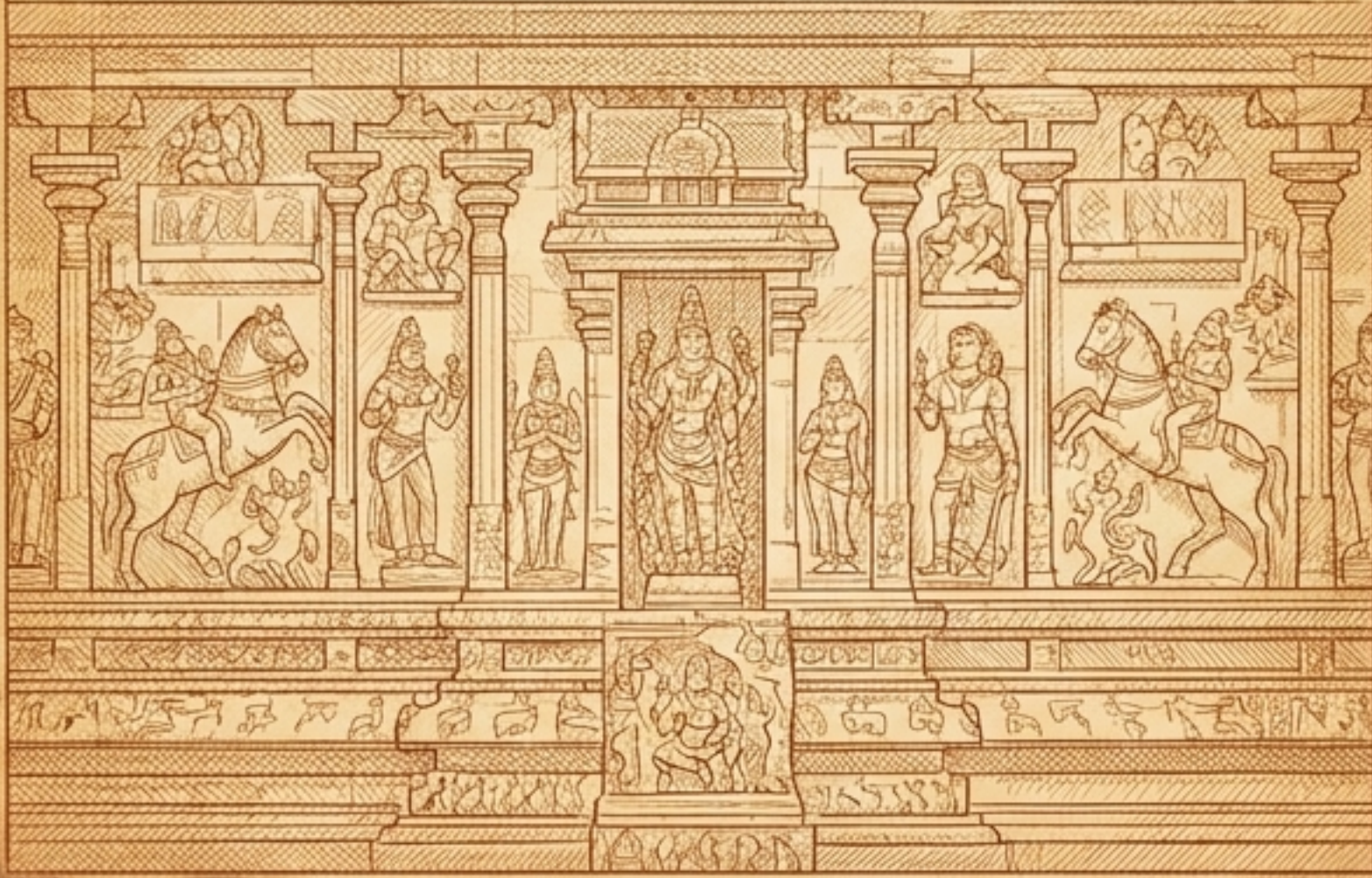
Unjustly executed in 1481 by a suspicious Sultan after Deccan nobles conspired against him, triggering imperial collapse.

The Clash of Administrations

	VIJAYANAGAR	BAHMANI
Supreme Authority	King is all-powerful in civil, military, judicial. High court of appeal with severe criminal punishments.	Sultan holds centralized power, supported heavily by brilliant Wazirs like Saif-ud-Din and Gawan.
Provincial Divisions	Empire divided into Kattans under Governors, then Tehsils, then village panchayats.	Empire divided into Tarafs under powerful Governors (later split into 8 to curb power).
Economic Drivers	Land revenue, diamond wealth, vibrant sea trade with Portugal, Dutch, China.	Agriculture, massive irrigation dams/canals, Arabian Sea to Bay of Bengal routes.
Social Tolerance	All castes prosperous. Women held high offices (judges, wrestlers), though Sati existed.	Deep internal instability. Many rulers were religious bigots who persecuted Hindu subjects.

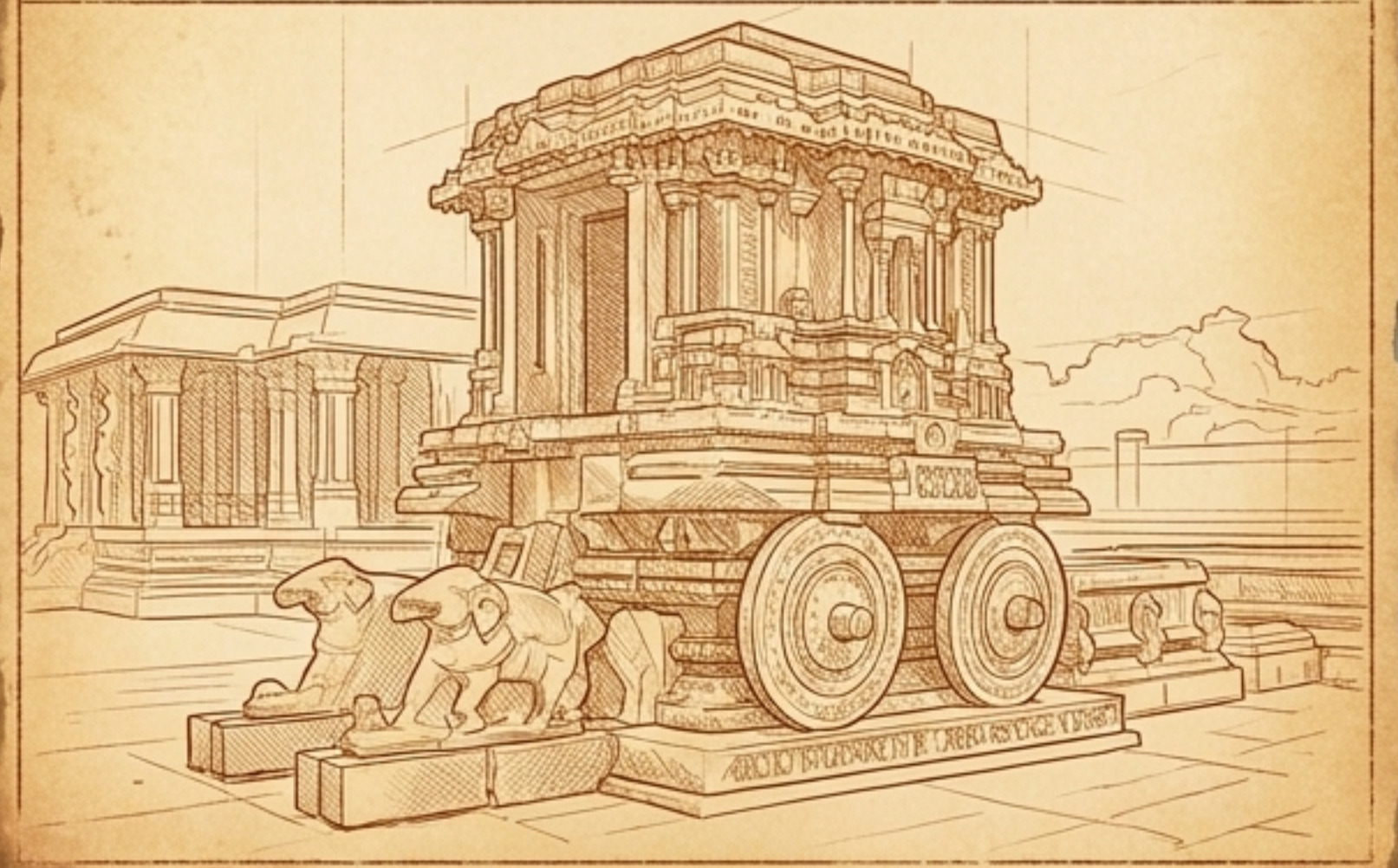
Granite & Devotion: Vijayanagar Architecture

Harasa Rama Temple



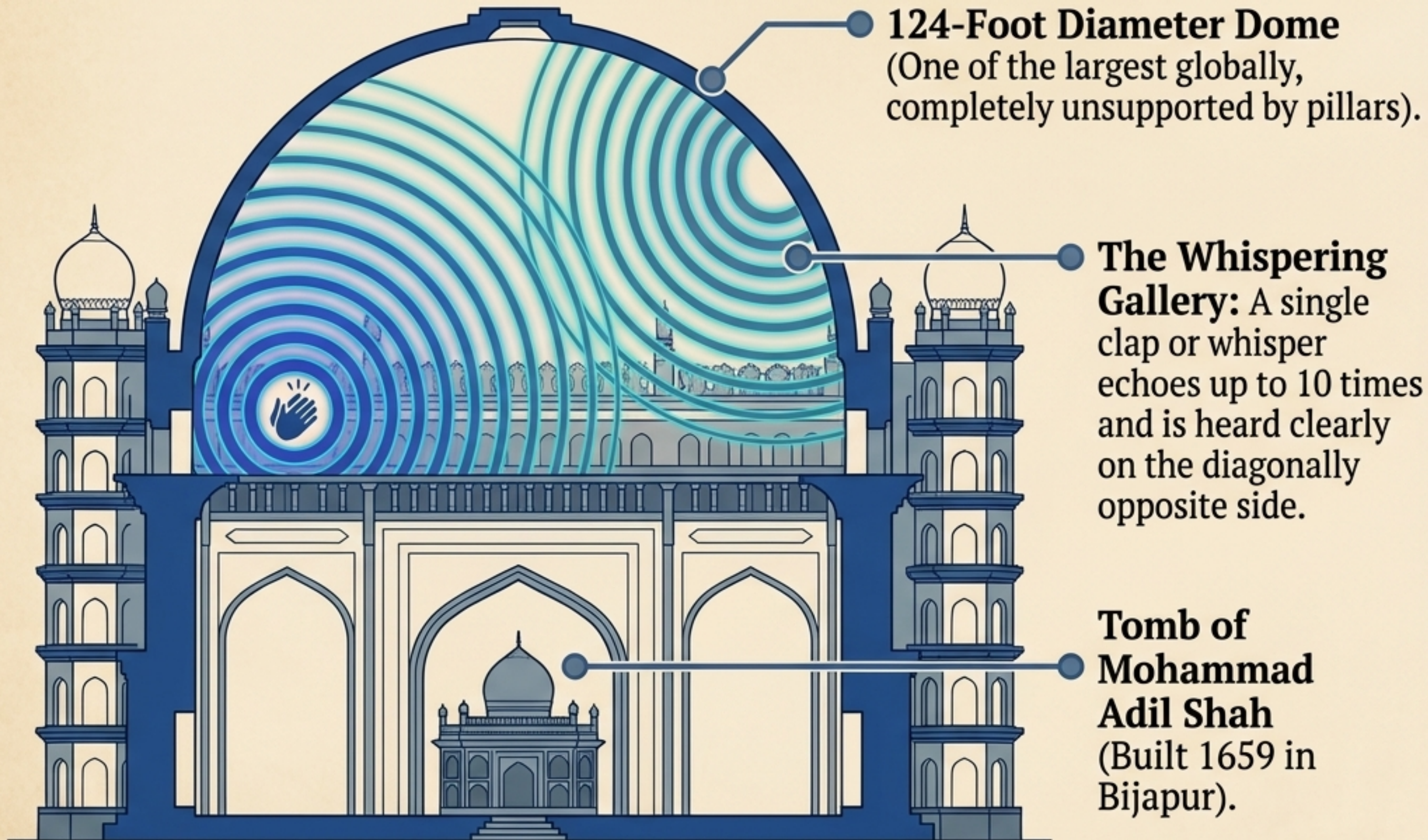
- Built by Krishna Deva Raya.
- "One of the most perfect specimens of Hindu temple architecture."
- Uniquely lacks a gopuram.
- Exterior walls completely wrapped in delicate sculptures of the Ramayana.

Vithala Temple



- Gigantic structure dedicated to Vishnu.
- Features massive solid granite rathas (chariots) with huge wheels in an open courtyard.
- Contains highly ornamented mandapas (pillared halls).
- Shows Chola, Pandya, and Chalukya stylistic influences.

Domes & Acoustics: Bahmani Architecture



Persian Influences

- Madrasa of Gawan (Bidar)

- Jama Masjid (Gulbarga)

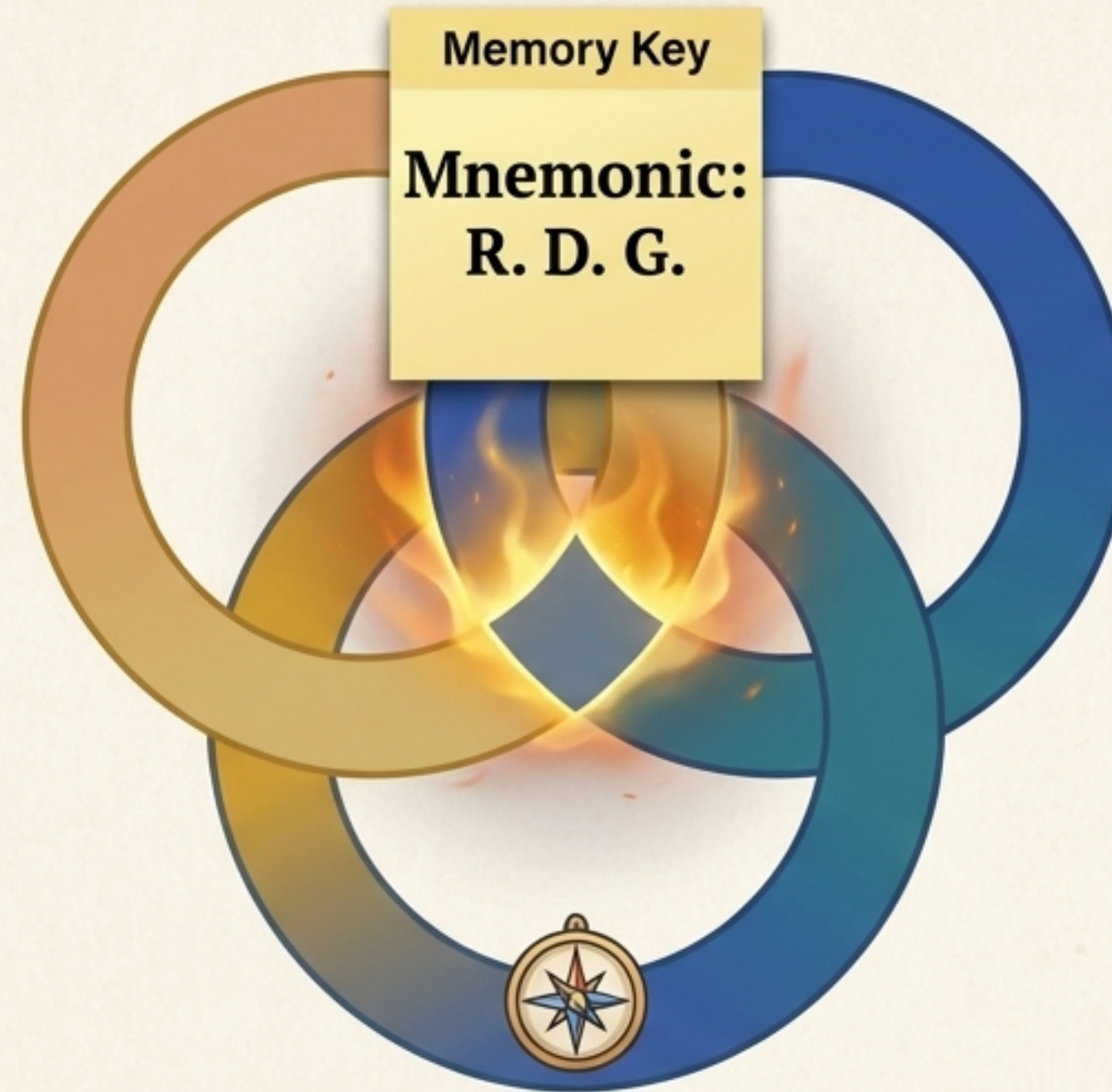
- Charminar
(Built 1591 to commemorate plague eradication)

The Causes of Endless Conflict



R – Raichur Doab

Control over the incredibly fertile, wealthy strip of land lying exactly between the Krishna and Tungabhadra rivers.



D – Diamonds of Golconda

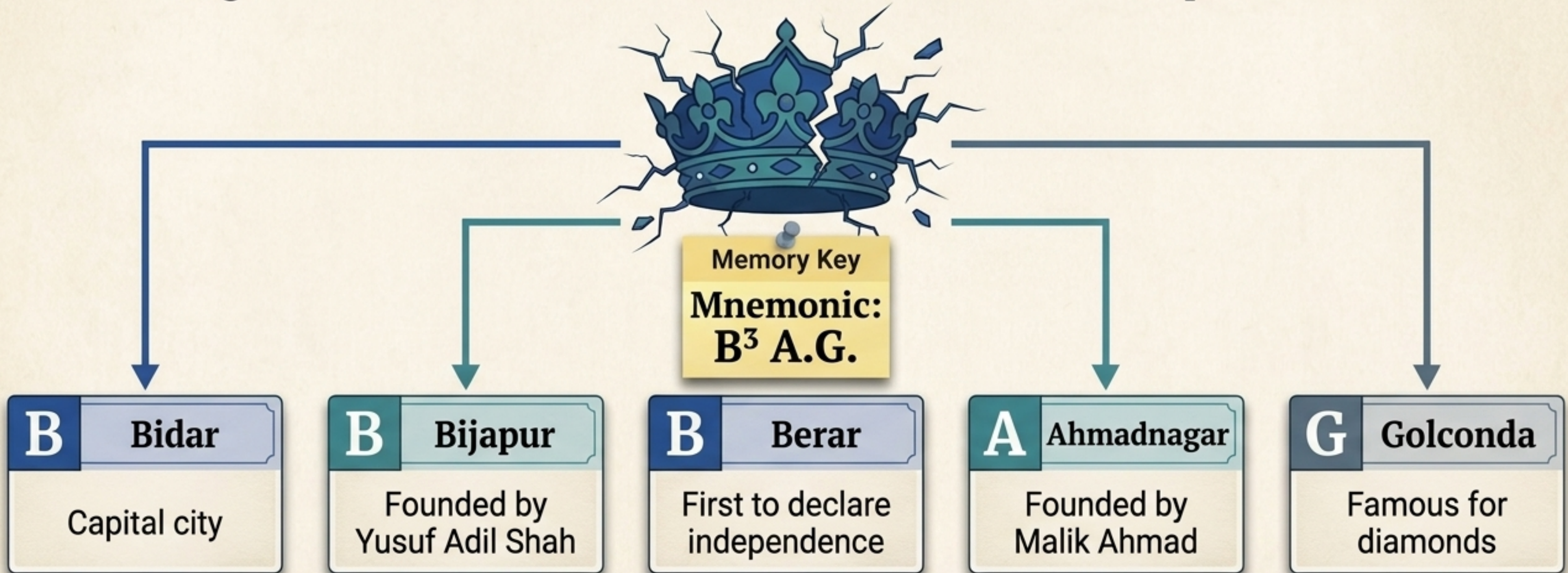
Both kingdoms wanted absolute control over Golconda because of its immense richness in diamond mines.

G – Geopolitical Supremacy

The ultimate ambition of both empires was to exert complete, uncontested control over the entire Southern Peninsula.

The Shattering of the Bahmani Sultanate

Following the unjust execution of Mohammad Gawan (1481), weak pleasure-seeking successors and constant noble discord caused the empire to crumble.



Takeaway: Divided, these five Muslim states would eventually unite for one final strike against Vijayanagar, before ultimately falling to the Mughals.

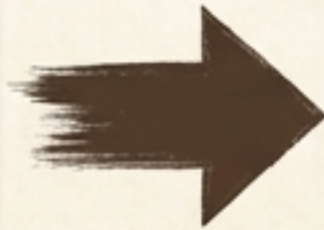
The Climax: The Battle of Talikot

1565 AD

A massive clash between the united forces of the splintered Bahmani states and the Vijayanagar Kingdom (under its last ruler, Sada Shiva).

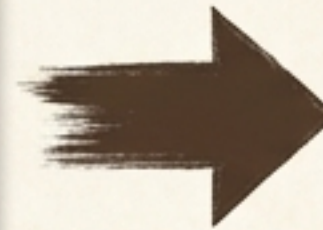
Total Defeat

The forces of the Vijayanagar Kingdom are completely outmatched and decisively defeated on the battlefield.



Capital Sacked

The once magnificent capital city of Hampi is ruthlessly invaded, plundered, and completely ruined.



End of an Era

The absolute and permanent end of the Vijayanagar Empire's dominance over the Southern Peninsula.

Synthesis: The Irony of Mutual Destruction

